

Aris Neos

Design & Research Leader | Head of Design (0 → 1 team building) | MBA

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PROFILE

Design and research leader with 10+ years shaping digital products across enterprise, e-commerce, and B2B SaaS — and 5+ years of continuous, escalating leadership experience across four companies, from informally organizing cross-functional teams to building a design and research function from zero. Proven track record hiring, managing, and shipping simultaneously: I stay close enough to the work to lead credibly, while owning product strategy, stakeholder alignment, and delivery. I set direction for how AI fits into design and research workflows — evidenced by a company-wide AI tooling initiative that cut costs 60%, and by my current role as my team's named AI Ambassador, mentoring designers on AI-native prototyping and design-system tooling — and I'm deepening my engineering fundamentals through a formal Computer Science degree.

EXPERIENCE

UX Lead, Pre-Booking Experience ETG Group

Aug 2025 – Present

- Leading UX strategy for ETG's flight booking funnel, mentoring a team of 5 designers across large-scale e-commerce experiences
- Own UX for Payments and an internal Fraud detection system as sole designer — building design's influence through direct stakeholder relationships, and approving or challenging roadmap items on technical/UX feasibility
- Shipped 2 major products across the booking flow, contributing to a €30–40k increase in daily sales
- Proposed and built a proof-of-concept for running local LLMs (12–32GB models) on existing team hardware as an alternative to cloud AI tools for routine coding, design, and research tasks — cut company-wide AI tooling costs by 60%
- Named AI Ambassador for the UX team on the strength of that work — evangelizing AI adoption and mentoring designers on building Figma agents and pairing Claude Code with Figma for prototyping
- Cut median prototyping time from a full 8-hour workday to roughly 2 hours by embedding AI into the prototyping workflow
- Built AI-assisted checks that keep design-system guidelines synchronized across working files automatically, reducing file inconsistency and clutter by 80%
- Established UX quality standards and review playbooks across the practice: design reviews, accessibility benchmarks, release readiness, and consistency validation

Head of Design (0 → 1 team building) WeatherXM

Jan 2024 – Aug 2025

- Built and led a design and research team from 1 to 4 (including self), hiring 3 designers across research, product design, and design systems — evaluated candidates using a custom 2-day design-thinking exercise focused on ambiguity, decision-making under pressure, and domain fluency over polish
- Built a standing research function: hired a dedicated research specialist who stood up two ongoing user research panels (Pro and core-app personas), turning one-off studies into a continuous pipeline of qualitative signal for product decisions
- Took design from a single point of failure to a distributed function: team velocity scaled from 1 feature per 3 weeks to up to 2 features per designer per week, removing design as the roadmap bottleneck
- Led the 0 → 1 launch of WeatherXM Pro, a B2B weather analytics platform: initial 20-day MVP shipped fast on business pressure but generated 1,200 monthly users and \$0 revenue with no clear value proposition
- Diagnosed the failure through 30+ user interviews, 2 focus groups, and persona research — identified Forecast Accuracy Tracking (FACT) as the real product wedge and validated it at industry meteo expos
- Scoped a 6-month redesign into 4 shippable phases rather than waiting for a full rebuild; phase 1 alone lifted conversion 0.1% → 2% within one month, with a 40% higher acceptance rate in post-mortem research
- Grew WeatherXM Pro to 5,000 unique users and \$10k monthly recurring revenue (from \$0), while the underlying station network scaled from 2,000 to 10,000+ worldwide
- Ran 4 executive workshops with the CEO and B2B stakeholders translating persona research into product and business decisions
- Set team culture and process for growth: flat structure with peer critique (including of own PRD/PM work), regular 1:1 coaching, a behavioral rubric for fair and consistent treatment, and a design system/playbook led by a dedicated team member to scale quality as the team grew

Senior Product/UX Designer → Design Lead UniSystems, Digital Transformation & Growth

Jan 2022 – May 2024

NDA-bound engagements — details generalized

- Led a team of 4 designers across multiple EU institution digital transformation projects while remaining a hands-on contributor — owning sprint planning, prioritization, and design strategy simultaneously
- Delivered 5 major EU digital transformation projects across enterprise systems, citizen-facing platforms, and service modernization initiatives, with 2 shipped ahead of schedule

- Acted as Design Chapter Lead across multiple teams, aligning UX strategy, stakeholder expectations, and technical delivery through workshops and executive presentations
- Increased PoC acceptance rates by 30% by improving UX quality, stakeholder alignment, and product feasibility across cross-functional initiatives
- Collaborated with developers to establish scalable design systems and accessibility practices, improving delivery consistency

Senior UX Designer & Researcher (Team Lead) Celestino — e-commerce B2C/B2B

Nov 2019 – Dec 2021

- Led a cross-functional team spanning marketing, data science, and front-end development — organizing sprint planning and daily task allocation as the senior member, without a formal management title
- Increased conversion rates by 10% through checkout optimization, user research, and data-driven UX improvements
- Conducted qualitative and quantitative research (interviews, heatmaps, A/B testing) to improve customer journeys and engagement
- Designed interactive prototypes in close collaboration with engineering to align UX, business goals, and technical feasibility
- Helped establish product measurement capabilities through analytics and experimentation tooling integration

Product Designer, Web & Mobile Plaisio · Praktiker · La Redoute · MyShoe · Buldoza SA

Apr 2015 – Nov 2019

- Designed and optimized e-commerce experiences across retail and fashion platforms, focusing on UX, conversion, and responsive design
- At Buldoza.gr: built and ran 5,000+ web and newsletter campaigns and automations, contributing to \$4.2m in sales over 3 years — an early hands-on blend of design and lightweight engineering (HTML/CSS templating, automation logic)
- At Praktiker: increased e-commerce portal engagement by 225% and kept sales stable through the Covid-19 disruption
- At N.I. Minoglou: led user research and design, increasing conversion rate by 20% year-over-year
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams to deliver customer-focused web and mobile experiences across retail and fashion clients

Experience Designer — Game Development Genesis Game Studios (Microsoft-incubated, Athens)

2012 – 2015

- Designed and developed games in C# / Unity as part of a Microsoft-incubated studio during formal game development study — direct engagement with Microsoft as part of the incubation track
- Contributed to multiple team-built titles alongside an independently released solo game
- One title reached 50,000 downloads within 3 months of launch
- Early foundation in systems thinking, interaction design, and shipping software under real deadlines — the root of the design + code hybrid approach carried through the rest of this CV

EDUCATION

BSc (Hons) Computer Science — Top-up degree, in progress

IST College / University partner programme · Started Oct 2026 · Expected completion 2027

MBA Global

University of Derby · Graduated 2023

Associate's Degree, Games Programming

SAE Athens · Graduated 2015

SKILLS

Leadership: Team building & hiring · 1-on-1s & mentoring · career frameworks · PRD / roadmap ownership · sprint planning & velocity · stakeholder alignment · workshop facilitation · cross-functional leadership

Research: User interviews & standing research panels · focus groups · survey design · persona development · Mixpanel/GA4 analysis · usability testing

Product & UX: UX strategy · design systems & playbooks · product discovery · accessibility (WCAG 2.1/2.2) · conversion optimization

AI & Technical: AI workflow strategy & enablement · AI adoption mentoring · Figma agents · Claude Code + Figma prototyping · local LLM deployment & tooling · React / React Native · TypeScript · HTML/CSS · C# (Unity) · SQL

Analytics: Mixpanel · GA4 · SQL · data-informed design